NEXA RETAIL

Shipping and Delivery Operations Guide

Operational guidance for dispatch, carrier tracking, delivery exceptions and return transport

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Purpose

This guide describes the shipment lifecycle from warehouse dispatch to customer delivery and the handling of common carrier exceptions. It also explains the transport events used for return parcels and how those events relate to warehouse and refund status.

1. Shipment Lifecycle

An order can move through preparation, dispatch, carrier transit and delivery as separate operational steps. Status values shown to the customer are simplified representations of those events and can update at different times across warehouse, carrier and customer-facing systems.

- Prepared - items are allocated and packed but may not yet be handed to a carrier.
- Dispatched - the shipment has left warehouse control or has been accepted into the carrier flow.
- In transit - the carrier is moving the parcel through its network.
- Out for delivery - the parcel is assigned to a local delivery route.
- Delivered - the carrier recorded delivery at the destination or an approved delivery location.

2. Standard Delivery Timing

Standard delivery is planned for 2-5 business days after dispatch for supported service areas. The target is not a guarantee for every order. Remote destinations, weather, campaign volume, customs steps where applicable and carrier incidents can extend the actual transit time.

Same-day or next-day services are offered only for eligible postcodes, products and order cut-off times. If the checkout did not confirm an expedited service, standard timing should be used for customer expectations.

3. Address Changes

Address changes are safest before dispatch. Once a parcel enters carrier handling, the carrier may reject an address change or require the recipient to use a delivery-management option. Support should not create a second shipment while the original parcel is still moving unless the fulfillment case has been reviewed.

3.1 Incorrect postcode or incomplete address

If the carrier reports an address issue, confirm the customer address and compare it with the shipping record. Minor corrections may be accepted by the carrier, while a materially different destination can require return-to-sender and a new order.

4. Delivered but Not Received

A Delivered carrier event should be checked together with proof of delivery, delivery location, household or reception details and any safe-place information. If the parcel cannot be located, open a carrier trace rather than immediately treating the order as lost.

4.1 Proof of delivery

Carrier evidence can include a timestamp, delivery location, recipient name, photo or geolocation depending on the service. The absence of one evidence type does not automatically prove non-delivery; use the records available for the shipment.

5. Damaged Parcel

Visible carrier damage should be recorded as early as possible. Where the customer receives the parcel, ask for photos of the outer package and damaged product before packaging is discarded. If the parcel is refused at delivery, the carrier return event should be linked to the order case.

6. Split Shipments and Missing Items

A single order can be fulfilled in more than one parcel. Before opening a missing-item investigation, confirm the number of shipment records and whether all parcels have been delivered. An item may be assigned to a later shipment even when other items from the order already arrived.

6.1 Warehouse packing discrepancy

If all expected shipments are delivered and an item remains missing, open a fulfillment review using the order, parcel and item details. Warehouse packing records can be compared with shipment weight or available packing evidence.

7. Return Transport

Return shipments use the return code or label created for the specific return request. The carrier return event tracks transport only; it does not determine whether the product will be accepted by the warehouse or whether a refund will be approved.

7.1 Common identifiers

- Order number - identifies the original customer purchase.
- Return reference - identifies the return request and selected items.
- Return-shipping code - authorizes or labels the carrier handoff for that return.
- Carrier tracking number - identifies the physical parcel movement.

Example ORD-2026-48192 may identify the order while RTN-583194 identifies a return request. They should not be described as the same reference.

7.2 Return Delivered status

A return parcel marked Delivered by the carrier may still be waiting for warehouse receipt and product matching. Customer-facing status should not jump directly from carrier delivery to Refund Complete.

8. Carrier Exceptions

8.1 No movement in tracking

A tracking event can remain unchanged between carrier hubs. Review the expected transit time, last scan location and any active carrier incident before opening a lost-parcel trace. Repeated duplicate traces for the same parcel should be avoided.

8.2 Return to sender

A shipment can be returned because of delivery failure, customer refusal, address problems or carrier restrictions. The returned parcel must still be received by the warehouse before stock or payment handling is completed.

8.3 Lost parcel investigation

Open a trace when the shipment is beyond the expected movement window or the carrier reports a possible loss. Keep the tracking number, last scan, parcel contents and order value in the case. A replacement or refund decision can depend on the investigation result and stock availability.

9. Campaign and Peak-Period Operations

Campaign periods can change dispatch cut-off times and carrier capacity. Customer-facing teams should use the actual order promise and active service notices instead of assuming that standard timing applies to every campaign order. Temporary carrier restrictions can also affect same-day and next-day options.

10. Communication Rules

- State the current shipment event and the next known operational step.
- Do not guarantee a delivery date that is not confirmed by the order promise or carrier.
- Distinguish carrier status from warehouse or refund status for return parcels.
- Record manual carrier instructions in the case when a temporary workaround is used.

11. Operational Escalation

Escalate when the shipment record and carrier record cannot be reconciled, the parcel is beyond the investigation threshold, a delivery proof dispute requires carrier review, or a return parcel cannot be matched at the warehouse.

11.1 Information to include

- Order number and shipment identifier.
- Carrier and tracking number.
- Last known scan and timestamp.
- Expected contents and parcel count.
- Customer-reported issue and any delivery evidence.
- Actions already taken with the carrier or warehouse.

12. Related Processes

- Return Process and Customer Requests - return eligibility and warehouse decision.
- Payments, Refunds and Invoicing - payment status after a return is approved.
- Customer Service Operations Notes - customer communication and escalation quality.